Fonqugon

COMMON FONQUGON OOZE

Fonqugons are small sapient oozes born from the living cradle colonies of Ossuun, a warm world of shallow oceans, freshwater basins, mineral marshes, and low continents divided by inland seas. Their translucent bodies contain one primary brain and numerous smaller neural bodies that move throughout their mass, allowing them to reshape themselves, process several streams of information, and distribute their attention between movement, sensory perception, and abstract thought.

Ossuun's settlements developed around overlapping environmental cycles. Seasonal rainfall, groundwater pressure, moon-driven tides, atmospheric rivers, microbial blooms, and animal migrations can allow a region to remain stable for decades before a particular convergence makes it flood, collapse, sour, or become unsuitable for habitation. Fonqugon civilization survived by sharing observations, maintaining public models, and treating uncertainty as something a community must understand together.

This history produced a culture in which possessing knowledge creates an obligation to the people affected by it. Fonqugons generally consider a decision incomplete when relevant evidence is concealed, affected populations cannot participate, or the consequences to surrounding ecosystems are excluded from consideration. Erbium Industries values Fonqugons as forecasters, analysts, coordinators, and maintenance workers, but treats the models they produce as corporate property and their distributed cognition as additional productive capacity.

Fonqugon reproduction remains dependent on cradle colonies, enormous stationary biological networks that grow through Ossuun's wetlands and submerged mineral shelves. These colonies produce new Fonqugons, preserve layered traces of communal knowledge, and maintain the microbial environments on which the ancestry depends. Settled Systems law classifies them as **sapient-supportive reproductive ecologies** rather than persons, permitting governments and corporations to license, relocate, quarantine, and seize them while claiming to protect Fonqugon continuity.

If you want to roleplay a physically adaptable systems thinker who can reshape their body, consider several problems at once, and decide what to do when vital knowledge belongs to the institution that paid to collect it, you should play a fonqugon.

You Might...

- Pause before answering while different portions of your mind compare evidence, consequences, and possible interpretations.
- Share information with people affected by a decision even when a contract, supervisor, or government office considers that information restricted.
- Reshape your body according to the task at hand, allowing unnecessary limbs or facial features to dissolve while your attention is directed elsewhere.

Others Probably...

- Assume your careful speech and long pauses indicate that you are unemotional, indecisive, or withholding information.
- Expect you to perform several cognitive tasks at once because your body contains multiple neural structures.
- Treat your ability to enter narrow spaces as proof that unsafe machinery was designed with you in mind.

Physical Description

Fonqugons are composed of dense, translucent biological gel surrounding one large primary brain and numerous smaller subordinate neural bodies. Their bodies shimmer under direct light and often appear green, purple, blue, brown, amber, or some mixture of several colors. Darker threads, knots, and suspended structures can be seen moving within them as their subordinate brains redistribute themselves.

A Fonqugon's subordinate brains are portions of one individual mind rather than separate personalities. They assist the primary brain by controlling distant parts of the body, processing sensory information, maintaining calculations, and comparing several possible responses. Damage to these structures can impair movement, memory, sensory processing, or concentration in much the same way that injury to a specialized organ affects another ancestry.

Most Fonqugons maintain a roughly humanoid form when interacting with other peoples, though the number and arrangement of their limbs can change. A Fonqugon performing delicate work might divide an arm into several narrow appendages, while one moving quickly might form additional legs for a few moments. A Fonqugon engaged in demanding thought may allow most of their limbs to dissolve, becoming a low mound or suspended mass while their neural bodies concentrate near the primary brain.

Two eyes and a mouthlike opening are common but optional. Fonqugons form these features because they make communication with other ancestries easier, not because their senses depend upon them. Any portion of a Fonqugon's surface can detect pressure, vibration, temperature, chemical traces, and movement. They can hear by interpreting sound waves travelling through their body and can smell or taste through direct contact with the surrounding air, water, or material.

Many Fonqugons maintain a familiar face around long-term companions. Others vary their features according to mood, context, fashion, or the sensory demands of a task. A face dissolving during a conversation does not necessarily indicate distress or dishonesty, though non-Fonqugons often interpret it that way.

Emotion influences how subordinate brains move through the body. Anxiety often draws them closer to the primary brain, reducing unnecessary movement and causing the Fonqugon to appear smaller or more compact. Excitement may send them rapidly through the body, producing restless appendages, rippling surfaces, or heightened sensory awareness. These reactions are tendencies rather than reliable methods of reading a Fonqugon's feelings.

Although they lack conventional bones, lungs, stomachs, and blood vessels, Fonqugons possess complex internal systems. They must breathe, eat, sleep, and recover from injury. Their bodies circulate nutrient-rich fluids and dissolved gases throughout their mass, and serious injuries can cause those fluids or subordinate brains to escape. Their malleability makes them difficult to restrain or crush, but it does not make them invulnerable.

Fonqugons usually stand between 3 and 4 feet tall when maintaining a humanoid posture. Their weight changes less dramatically than their shape, as extending a limb redistributes existing mass rather than creating additional material. A Fonqugon can compress into a broad low form or stretch themselves taller for short periods, though most develop a preferred resting shape.

Society

Ossuun is a warm, water-rich terrestrial world orbiting a stable orange K-type star. Its surface is divided among shallow oceans, immense freshwater basins, broad floodplains, mineral marshes, submerged cave systems, and low continents crossed by inland seas. Much of the planet's land is only temporarily dry, and settlements are designed to move, float, separate, or allow water to pass through them.

Two moons in a stable resonance generate powerful tidal cycles that interact with Ossuun's rainfall, groundwater, and atmospheric circulation. These cycles are predictable individually, but their intersections can produce sudden environmental changes. A floodplain that has supported a settlement for several generations may become chemically hostile after a shift in sediment, microbial life, or upstream water pressure. Fonqugon communities therefore maintain extensive records of local conditions and continuously revise their expectations.

Fonqugon society does not assume that complex problems possess one perfect mathematical answer. Instead, Fonqugons ask whether the decision includes sufficient **coverage**. Coverage refers to the people, evidence, assumptions, environments, uncertainties, and future consequences represented in a decision. A proposal that produces an efficient result while excluding an affected community is considered under-covered regardless of the quality of its calculations.

Major decisions are made through temporary assemblies called **confluences**. A confluence is convened for a specific question and dissolved after that question has been addressed. Participants publish the evidence they used, identify the populations they believe will be affected, document known uncertainties, and explain why they accepted one course of action over another.

Confluences are not limited to technical specialists. A housing decision might include structural engineers, residents, caregivers, food workers, artists, environmental observers, and anyone else whose knowledge describes a relevant consequence. Emotional well-being is treated as legitimate information because fear, grief, trust, exhaustion, and resentment affect how communities respond to policy.

The process is often slow. Disputes arise over which populations count as affected, how much uncertainty is acceptable, and whether further observation would meaningfully change the decision. A participant can delay a confluence by introducing large quantities of marginally relevant information or repeatedly demanding new models. Some Fonqugons believe these weaknesses justify permanent executives or stronger emergency authorities, while others consider centralized power more dangerous than procedural delay.

During immediate emergencies, communities appoint temporary coordinators who can act without full coverage. These decisions must later be reviewed in an open confluence. The coordinator is expected to disclose what they knew, what they assumed, whose interests they prioritized, and what harm resulted. Honest emergency errors are generally tolerated more readily than attempts to conceal or retroactively alter the available evidence.

Fonqugons are not uniformly scientists or mathematicians. Their culture values the ability to explain how one reached a conclusion, but a cook, performer, mechanic, medic, caregiver, or artist may contribute forms of knowledge that cannot be reduced to a numerical model. Many Fonqugons are suspicious of people who treat quantification as proof that a conclusion is objective.

Communities are organized around watersheds, settlements, and cradle colonies rather than permanent nation-states. Several communities may share responsibility for one colony, while a large settlement may depend on several distinct colonies. Planetary confluences are rare and generally address issues such as orbital infrastructure, interregional migration, major environmental interventions, or the legal relationship between Ossuun and the Settled Systems.

The Star Dream brought Fonqugons into contact with peoples whose governments relied on permanent legislatures, executive offices, corporate ownership, and restricted information. Many Fonqugons admired the speed and coordination these institutions made possible. Others were alarmed by how frequently decisions were made by people insulated from their consequences.

Erbium Industries presents its own hierarchy as a practical solution to the inefficiency of Fonqugon governance. Corporate material describes confluences as valuable community-consultation traditions while emphasizing that trained administrators must retain final authority over infrastructure, transportation, and emergency response.

Beliefs

Fonqugon beliefs vary between communities, but most begin from the understanding that no individual exists independently of the systems that sustain them. A Fonqugon depends on a cradle colony, that colony depends on water and microbial life, those ecosystems depend on surrounding communities, and those communities depend on decisions made far beyond any single settlement.

This interdependence does not require self-sacrifice in every situation. Fonqugons recognize privacy, personal boundaries, competing needs, and the danger of allowing a community to claim unlimited authority over an individual. Their central ethical question is usually whether the people affected by a decision possess enough information and influence to respond meaningfully.

Knowledge creates responsibility. A Fonqugon who discovers an unsafe water supply, structural defect, environmental hazard, or false public claim is expected to inform the people placed at risk. Withholding that knowledge because an employer owns the instruments that collected it is widely regarded as an attempt to exclude those people from a decision about their own lives.

Fonqugons distinguish privacy from secrecy. Privacy protects a person’s control over their own experiences and vulnerabilities. Secrecy prevents affected people from understanding a decision imposed upon them. Fonqugon communities frequently disagree over where one ends and the other begins.

Cradle colonies occupy an uncertain position in Fonqugon belief. Some consider them sacred ancestors or communal minds. Others regard them as complex ecosystems without an individual consciousness. Many reject both positions and argue that the colonies possess forms of awareness for which ordinary categories such as person, organism, archive, and habitat are inadequate.

The official Settled Systems classification of cradle colonies as sapient-supportive reproductive ecologies is viewed with suspicion even among Fonqugons who do not believe the colonies are persons. The classification answers an unresolved biological and ethical question in the manner most convenient for governments, insurers, and corporate property law.

Popular Edicts share consequential knowledge with those it affects, preserve accurate records, identify what a decision has omitted, acknowledge uncertainty, protect cradle colonies, revise your conclusions when better evidence becomes available

Popular Anathema knowingly conceal an immediate danger from those exposed to it, falsify evidence to justify a predetermined decision, destroy communal records, treat uncertainty as permission to ignore harm, claim ownership over another person's thoughts, deliberately damage a healthy cradle colony

Sample Names

Fonqugon personal names are usually short and contain clear vowel sounds separated by stops or repeated consonants. Common names include Doku, Kett, Luma, Mebb, Nori, Paku, Rodd, Tavi, Ullo, Vek, Yaru, and Zobb.

A formal Fonqugon name identifies the cradle colony that produced them or the community archive that accepted responsibility for their early development. Examples include **Tavi of Hollow Reed**, **Kett of the Ninth Current**, **Luma of Siltglass Cradle**, **Paku of Deep Bloom**, and **Vek of the Western Mineral Shelf**.

Offworld-born Fonqugons may use the name of a continuity facility, but many replace corporate registry designations with names chosen by the Fonqugon community maintaining the colony. A facility registered as **Erbium Biological Continuity Site 44-C** might be called **Warmwater Shelter** by the people born there.

Other Information

Ossuun

Ossuun's danger comes from ecological complexity rather than constant devastation. Its weather, tides, wetlands, and living systems are individually understandable, but their interactions produce conditions that can change quickly after long periods of apparent stability.

Fonqugon settlements use curved platforms, flexible bridges, floating districts, submerged chambers, and narrow passages suited to malleable bodies. Permanent structures are designed to redirect water rather than stop it entirely. Many buildings contain textured walls, ceiling routes, recessed resting spaces, and internal channels that allow Fonqugons to travel without maintaining a humanoid form.

Settlements regularly relocate portions of their infrastructure as watercourses shift. A civic building may be separated into modules and moved to another part of the basin rather than abandoned. Structures that remain behind are documented so future communities know what materials, contaminants, and hazards were introduced to the environment.

Ossuun possesses extensive orbital monitoring infrastructure. Weather observation, lunar measurements, groundwater imaging, and biosphere surveys are treated as public necessities. Erbium has repeatedly attempted to consolidate these systems under standardized relay management, arguing that fragmented local data prevents effective planetary forecasting.

Fonqugon confluences have accepted some Erbium infrastructure while resisting exclusive corporate control of the resulting information. Disputes over who owns orbital observations, environmental models, and cradle-colony health records remain one of the principal sources of conflict between Ossuun and the Settled Systems.

Cradle Colonies

A cradle colony is an enormous stationary biological network composed of fibrous growths, translucent membranes, mineral structures, microbial communities, and chambers filled with nutrient-rich gel. Colonies grow through freshwater shelves, submerged caverns, mineral marshes, and regions where geothermal activity brings dissolved nutrients close to the surface.

Mature colonies sometimes begin forming neural tissue within protected chambers. Over time, one primary brain and numerous subordinate brains organize within a body of gel. The developing Fonqugon eventually separates from the colony as an independent person.

No individual determines when this process occurs. The frequency of births depends on the colony's health, accumulated nutrients, microbial balance, environmental stress, and conditions that Fonqugons do not yet fully understand. Attempts to force reproduction usually damage the colony or produce incomplete development.

Fonqugons can immerse part of their bodies into a healthy colony and contribute sensory impressions, measurements, emotional states, and neural patterns. These traces accumulate alongside the records of previous generations. The colony does not preserve complete personalities or allow descendants to retrieve an ancestor's memories intact. Information must be reconstructed by comparing overlapping impressions, environmental records, and patterns preserved in different portions of the colony.

A colony therefore serves as reproductive habitat, ecological partner, community archive, and living witness. Destroying one eliminates future births, damages the surrounding ecosystem, and erases knowledge that may exist nowhere else.

During the Star Dream, every healthy cradle colony on Ossuun began producing matching electrical and chemical patterns at the same stamp. Fonqugons connected to the colonies experienced fragments of Drift mathematics, machine principles, navigation, and distant stars passing through their distributed minds.

Settled Systems authorities recognized Fonqugons among the Elect but ruled that the colonies had transmitted the revelation without comprehending it. Under Settled Systems Code `A2%8&3-11`, cradle colonies are classified as **sapient-supportive reproductive ecologies**. They receive ecological and cultural protections but possess no independent standing, right of refusal, ownership, or representation.

The distinction allows a cradle colony to be quarantined, relocated, licensed, transferred between institutions, or destroyed under emergency authority without the procedures required for action against a person.

Offworld Continuity

Establishing an offworld cradle colony requires compatible water chemistry, mineral content, microorganisms, pressure, temperature, and long-term ecological stability. A colony can survive in an artificial habitat, but it cannot be reduced to a tank of nutrient gel without eventually deteriorating.

Erbium Industries owns much of the equipment used to establish and maintain offworld colonies. Its holdings include filtration systems, microbial cultures, nutrient formulas, environmental processors, monitoring software, transport containers, and licensed stabilization hardware.

Settled Systems Code `A7%6&4-2` requires offworld cradle colonies to operate under biological-continuity and invasive-ecology permits. The regulation addresses genuine dangers. An improperly established colony can die slowly, contaminate local ecosystems, or develop neural structures incapable of completing healthy formation. Those risks also allow authorities to deny permits to independent Fonqugon communities while approving Erbium-operated facilities.

Erbium does not claim ownership of the Fonqugons born within its facilities. Instead, it assigns a portion of the colony’s construction, transport, maintenance, and environmental debt to the continuity cohort produced there. The company describes these obligations as repayment for publicly supported developmental resources.

Fonqugons raised in corporate facilities may spend decades working against the costs associated with their own birth. If a colony’s accounts become delinquent, Erbium can reduce nutrient shipments, suspend technical support, or petition for emergency custodianship without formally threatening the lives dependent upon it.

Ambering

A cradle colony subjected to prolonged contamination, starvation, neural damage, or environmental instability may begin **ambering**. Its translucent membranes become cloudy gold or rust-colored, its stored patterns fragment, and its reproductive chambers begin forming unstable biological structures.

Some amber-born organisms are simple parasites that imitate Fonqugon shapes or follow traces of remembered behavior. Others reproduce fragments of speech, learned motions, emotional responses, or sensory memories preserved by the colony.

Settled Systems authorities classify all amber-born organisms as nonsapient pathological mimics. Immediate destruction is standard procedure. Fonqugons remain divided over whether every amber-born organism is a parasite, whether some are malformed children, or whether damaged colonies can produce forms of personhood that existing tests fail to recognize.

Erbium cites the danger of ambering when arguing that independent colonies require corporate supervision. Its biological research divisions also maintain restricted programs studying whether ambering can be predicted, delayed, reversed, or deliberately induced.

Place in the Settled Systems

Fonqugons are heavily recruited into environmental forecasting, logistics, Drift-route analysis, infrastructure coordination, disaster modeling, ecological surveys, resource projection, actuarial work, and labor-behavior assessment. Their ability to compare several information streams at once makes them valuable wherever a system must be monitored continuously.

Settled Systems Code `A4%12&2-6` permits employers to conduct role-specific **distributed cognitive capacity assessments** for workers with multiple neural structures. These assessments establish how many concurrent processes a Fonqugon can be expected to maintain during normal operations.

The subordinate brains do not qualify as separate workers for wages, representation, service credit, medical coverage, or legal standing. Erbium explains that they are inseparable portions of one employee. For productivity quotas, those same structures are treated as independently available processing capacity.

Fonqugon analysts frequently produce models that management uses without granting them authority over the resulting decision. A Fonqugon may forecast a refinery failure, ecological collapse, supply shortage, or dangerous rise in worker unrest. The report can then be classified, revised, delayed, or presented without its uncertainty ranges.

When disaster follows, the analyst may be held responsible for insufficient confidence, unclear communication, or failure to produce a model that compelled management to act. Corporate review rarely treats the deliberate rejection of a forecast as an analytical failure by the administrators who rejected it.

Fonqugon physiology also makes them common maintenance workers. Many Erbium facilities contain **malleable-access conduits**, narrow passages intended for Fonqugon technicians to enter machinery, pressure systems, ventilation assemblies, and structural cavities.

Erbium describes these conduits as ancestry-responsive workplace design. Workers point out that the company created spaces without ordinary emergency access because assigning a Fonqugon was cheaper than constructing equipment that could be serviced safely.

Fonqugons are sometimes viewed with suspicion in information-sensitive professions. Their cultural expectation that affected people should receive consequential knowledge conflicts with nondisclosure agreements, proprietary forecasting, sealed investigations, and compartmentalized corporate records.

A Fonqugon who distributes a hazard model to exposed workers may believe they are completing the decision-making process. Erbium and the Settled Systems courts classify the same act as unauthorized disclosure of protected institutional property.

Fonqugon Mechanics

Hit Points

6

Size

Small

Speed

20 feet
Climb 5 feet

Attribute Boosts

Constitution, Intelligence, Free

Attribute Flaw

Charisma

Languages

Common
Ossic
One regional language of your choice

Additional languages equal to your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

Low-Light Vision

You can see in dim light as though it were bright light, and you ignore the concealed condition due to dim light.

Oozy

You're an ooze! You can Climb surfaces without needing to attempt an Athletics check even if they're perfectly smooth or horizontal, such as a metal ceiling, though the GM might still require you to attempt a check to Climb while in hazardous conditions.

Additionally, as long as your primary and subordinate brains can fit through a gap, your whole body can ooze through it. You can move through a gap at least 2 feet wide without Squeezing and can Squeeze through a gap at least 1 foot wide.

Heritages

Fonqugon Heritages

During the final stages of a Fonqugon's development within a cradle colony, their growth is influenced by the chemical, electrical, biological, and environmental conditions passing through the colony. These conditions can produce lasting adaptations in the developing Fonqugon.

The most common Fonqugon heritages reflect recurring environmental phenomena found throughout Ossuun's freshwater basins, mineral marshes, shallow seas, and submerged shelves. Choose one of the following Fonqugon heritages at 1st level.

Acid Quake Fonqugon

Some cradle colonies grow above unstable mineral shelves where changes in groundwater pressure can fracture stone and release concentrated corrosive brines. These events can poison entire wetland regions, though colonies that survive repeated exposure sometimes produce Fonqugons adapted to sense the movement below and resist the released chemicals.

As an acid quake Fonqugon, you're especially attuned to the ground around you and can withstand mild corrosives. You gain imprecise tremorsense with a range of 15 feet and acid resistance equal to half your level, with a minimum resistance of 1.

Fire Flood Fonqugon

Some of Ossuun's freshwater basins periodically become infested with rapidly multiplying microbial mats. When these colonies die, they release flammable oils and gases into the surrounding water. Lightning, geothermal discharge, or industrial equipment can ignite the contaminated surface just as a tidal surge forces the burning water beyond its ordinary banks.

As a fire flood Fonqugon, you’re especially hardy, like the cradle colony that survived a fire flood while forming you. You gain 8 Hit Points from your ancestry instead of 6, and you gain fire resistance equal to half your level, with a minimum resistance of 1.

Lightning Wave Fonqugon

The resonant motions of Nebb and Yaru generate powerful tides across Ossuun’s shallow seas. When certain tidal alignments coincide with electrical storm systems, immense charges travel across the water in rolling discharges. Arcs can cross floodplains, strike floating settlements, and travel through the wet ground surrounding distant cradle colonies.

As a lightning wave Fonqugon, the sudden electrical shocks experienced during your development made you quick to react and capable of withstanding further shocks. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to initiative rolls made with Perception, and you gain electricity resistance equal to half your level, with a minimum resistance of 1.

Psychic Blight Fonqugon

Some microbial infections can enter a cradle colony’s neural membranes and excite the sensory impressions and neural patterns stored within them. An affected colony may produce uncontrolled movements, repeated fragments of remembered speech, intrusive emotions, and conflicting sensory signals until it contains the infection.

Cradle colonies usually suspend reproduction while recovering. Occasionally, a healthy Fonqugon completes development within an isolated chamber and emerges with a mind adapted to constant neural interference.

As a psychic blight Fonqugon, your mind has adapted to withstand mental intrusion. You gain a +1 circumstance bonus to saving throws against mental effects, and you gain mental resistance equal to half your level, with a minimum resistance of 1.

Sonic Aurora Fonqugon

Charged particles from Ossuun’s orange sun occasionally interact with the planet’s magnetic field at destructive angles. The resulting auroras are accompanied by intense flashes, electrical discharges, and atmospheric pressure waves that can travel across entire wetland basins as deep, sustained booms.

As a sonic aurora Fonqugon, you're especially sensitive to light, vibration, and sound. You gain a +2 circumstance bonus to Perception checks to Seek, and you gain sonic resistance equal to half your level, with a minimum resistance of 1.